RAJASTHANI COLLECTION

NO. 05



RAJASTHAN ORIGIN

Papad Ki Sabzi

Lentil Wafer Curry

When Even Papad Becomes the Vegetable

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

LICENSE & COPYRIGHT NOTICE

Papad Ki Sabzi

Sold via: Gumroad
Publisher: DhanioDigital (dhaniodigital.gumroad.com)

PERSONAL USE LICENSE

This digital cookbook is licensed for personal, non-commercial use only.
You may print one (1) copy for your own kitchen use.

YOU MAY NOT:

- Share, resell, or redistribute this file in any form
- Upload to any website, cloud service, or file-sharing platform
- Remove or obscure any watermarks, copyright notices, or branding
- Use recipes for commercial food service without written permission

Violation of this license may result in legal action.

© 2024 DhanioDigital. All rights reserved.
Contact: support@dhaniodigital.com

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Papad Ki Sabzi

AUTHOR

Sweta Verma

PUBLISHER

DhanioDigital

COPYRIGHT

© 2026 Sweta Verma. All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced or distributed without written permission from the publisher.

DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Turning a Snack into a Curry

Papad ki sabzi represents perhaps the most surprising expression of Rajasthani desert cooking's core philosophy: if fresh vegetables aren't available, find something shelf-stable and turn it into a curry regardless. Papad — thin, dried lentil or gram flour wafers, typically eaten as a crisp snack or side after roasting or frying — becomes, in this dish, the main vegetable-like component of an entirely different kind of meal.

The technique breaks papad into pieces and simmers them in a spiced, tangy yogurt-based gravy until they soften and absorb the sauce, transforming from a crisp snack into something closer to a soft dumpling in texture. It's a dish that surprises people unfamiliar with Rajasthani cuisine, precisely because papad's usual role — a crunchy, dry accompaniment — is turned completely inside out.

Like gatte ki sabzi and mangodi ki sabzi elsewhere in this collection, papad ki sabzi exists because Rajasthan's desert communities historically needed reliable, long-lasting pantry staples that could become a satisfying curry on short notice, regardless of season or vegetable availability — a genuinely practical solution that has become a beloved dish in its own right.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Turning a Snack into a Curry, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

Represents an unusual and distinctly Rajasthani approach to desert cooking, transforming a typically crisp snack food into the main component of a curry. Reflects the same resourceful philosophy found in gatte ki sabzi and mangodi ki sabzi, all built from shelf-stable pantry staples rather than fresh vegetables. A dish that often surprises newcomers to Rajasthani cuisine, given how unexpected the transformation of papad into a soft curry component is. A genuine reflection of how necessity shaped creative, distinctive cooking in Rajasthan's demanding desert climate.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

10m	15m	4	Easy
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Kadai or wide pan
- Whisk

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Papad ki sabzi is best enjoyed fresh, as the papad pieces continue to soften and can turn overly mushy with extended storage. It keeps refrigerated for a day if needed, though the texture will have changed noticeably from freshly made.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the dish

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Plain lentil or gram flour papad, uncooked (not roasted or fried)	6–8	6–8	6–8
Plain yogurt, whisked	1 cup	240 g	1 katori
Besan (gram flour)	1 tbsp	8 g	1 chammach
Water	1½ cups	360 ml	1½ katori
Oil or ghee	3 tbsp	45 ml	3 chammach
Mustard seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Cumin seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Asafoetida (hing)	pinch	pinch	chutki bhar
Ginger-garlic paste	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Turmeric powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Red chili powder	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Coriander powder	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Salt	¾ tsp	4.5 g	to taste
Fresh coriander, chopped, for garnish	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

Look for plain, uncooked papad specifically labeled for roasting or frying, made from urad dal or moong dal — avoid pre-seasoned or flavored varieties, which can clash with this dish's spicing. Papad is widely available at Indian grocers worldwide, sold in stacked packages, making this a fairly accessible dish to recreate outside India.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · STEP-BY-STEP

Making Papad Ki Sabzi

01 BREAK THE PAPAD

Break the uncooked papad into bite-sized pieces, about 1–2 inches each. Set aside.

02 WHISK THE YOGURT BASE

Whisk the yogurt and besan together until smooth, then gradually whisk in the water.

03 TEMPER THE SPICES

Heat oil in a kadai and add mustard seeds, letting them pop. Add cumin seeds and asafoetida, letting them sizzle, then the ginger-garlic paste, cooking until fragrant.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

Making Papad Ki Sabzi, continued



04 ADD SPICES AND THE YOGURT BASE

Add turmeric, chili powder, and coriander powder, stirring briefly. Reduce heat to low and add the yogurt-besan mixture, stirring constantly for the first minute to prevent splitting.

05 SIMMER THE GRAVY

Simmer for 8–10 minutes, until slightly thickened and the raw besan taste is gone.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

Making Papad Ki Sabzi, continued



06 ADD THE PAPAD PIECES

Add the broken papad pieces and salt, gently folding to coat. Simmer for a final 4–5 minutes, just until the papad softens and absorbs some of the gravy while still holding together.

Texture indicator. the papad should be tender but still recognizable as distinct pieces, softened throughout but not dissolved into the gravy.

07 GARNISH AND SERVE

Finish with fresh coriander and serve immediately.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

STEP BY STEP · STEP-BY-STEP

Making Papad Ki Sabzi, continued

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Adding the papad too early or simmering it too long causes it to disintegrate entirely into the gravy. Add it toward the very end and simmer only briefly.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served hot with roti or rice, a quick and practical Rajasthani home-cooking solution.
- A reliable dish for days when fresh vegetables aren't on hand.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Family Style

- A fast, comforting weeknight dish that comes together with minimal fresh ingredients.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Timing Right

- Adding the papad at the very end and simmering only briefly is the single most important technique for this dish.
- Gentle heat when adding the yogurt-besan base prevents splitting, just as with other yogurt-based Rajasthani curries.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- The yogurt gravy base can be made ahead and reheated, with papad added fresh just before serving for the best texture.
- This is one of the quickest dishes in the collection, making extensive advance prep rarely necessary.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some cooks lightly roast the papad pieces briefly before adding them to the gravy, giving a subtle toasted flavor that comes through even after softening.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

175 kcal	7 g	16 g	10 g	3 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with ghee and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Gluten, Mustard, Sesame. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Classic Papad Ki Sabzi	the tangy yogurt-based version featured here.
Dry Papad Ki Sabzi	a less saucy version with papad tossed in a drier spice mixture rather than a full gravy.
Papad Ki Sabzi with Peas	some households add green peas for extra texture and color.

What kind of papad should I use?

Plain, uncooked lentil or gram flour papad, not pre-roasted, pre-fried, or flavored varieties, which can clash with the dish's spicing.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Why did my papad dissolve completely?

Likely added too early or simmered too long. Add papad pieces only in the final few minutes of cooking.

Is this dish very spicy?

It has moderate warmth from the chili powder, adjustable to taste — not among the spicier dishes in Rajasthani cuisine.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Papad	thin, dried lentil or gram flour wafers, transformed into the main component of this curry.
Besan	gram flour, used to thicken the yogurt-based gravy.
Tadka	a tempering of spices bloomed in hot oil, essential to this dish's flavor base.
Sabzi	Hindi for a vegetable curry or side dish, applied here to a non-vegetable ingredient.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Papad Ki Sabzi

10m	15m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
4	Easy
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

DISH

Plain lentil or gram flour papad	6–8
Plain yogurt	240 g
Besan	8 g
Water	360 ml
Oil or ghee	45 ml
Mustard seeds	4 g
Cumin seeds	4 g
Asafoetida	pinch
Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
Turmeric powder	1.5 g
Red chili powder	3 g
Coriander powder	3 g
Salt	4.5 g
Fresh coriander	8 g

METHOD

01 **Break the papad.** Break the uncooked papad into bite-sized pieces, about 1–2 inches each.

02 **Whisk the yogurt base.** Whisk the yogurt and besan together until smooth, then gradually whisk in the water.

03 **Temper the spices.** Heat oil in a kadai and add mustard seeds, letting them pop.

04 **Add spices and the yogurt base.** Add turmeric, chili powder, and coriander powder, stirring briefly.

05 **Simmer the gravy.** Simmer for 8–10 minutes, until slightly thickened and the raw besan taste is gone.

06 **Add the papad pieces.** Add the broken papad pieces and salt, gently folding to coat.

07 **Garnish and serve.** Finish with fresh coriander and serve immediately.

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com

BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Plain lentil or gram flour papad	6–8	☐ Plain yogurt	240 g
☐ Besan	8 g	☐ Oil or ghee	45 ml
☐ Mustard seeds	4 g	☐ Cumin seeds	4 g
☐ Asafoetida	pinch	☐ Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
☐ Turmeric powder	1.5 g	☐ Red chili powder	3 g
☐ Coriander powder	3 g	☐ Salt	4.5 g
☐ Fresh coriander	8 g		

© DhanioDigital · Personal use only · Not for redistribution · dhaniodigital.gumroad.com